

Protagonist Profiles

In *Zero Sum*, you don't play super-spies or elite commandos. You play people who were just doing their jobs until they dug too deep.

Backgrounds (Archetypes)

- **The Whistleblower:** Corporate insider, accountant, or data analyst. You have the evidence, but no one to trust. (Skills: Bureaucracy, Data Analysis, Encryption).
- **The Investigative Journalist:** You know how to find the truth, but your editor just killed the story. (Skills: Interrogation, Research, Streetwise).
- **The Burned Asset:** Ex-police or low-level intelligence. You know how the system works, and that's why they want you dead. (Skills: Surveillance, Firearms, Evasion).
- **The Hacktivist:** You live in the digital shadows, but this time, you breached a server that fights back. (Skills: Hacking, Electronic Warfare, Forgery).

Resources & Ties

Characters start with a limited pool of **Resources** (stashed cash, burner phones, fake IDs) and **Ties** (contacts who might help them). However, every time a Tie is used, the GM rolls to see if the contact is compromised, leading the conspiracy right to the players.